

concern is the marine police, drawn from the state police, who are meant to patrol a 5-km belt of coastline. Months after the attacks, the Home Ministry speedily sanctioned the construction of 168 modern speedboats at the state-owned defence shipyards Goa Shipyard Ltd and the Garden Reach Shipyard Limited, Kolkata. These boats were to be handed out to the coastal states of Maharashtra, Gujarat, Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu, Orissa and West Bengal. As of September, only 22 interceptor boats were delivered against the target of 36 boats. At the current rate of production at the shipyards, officials admit it will be difficult to have all 168 boats in the water by next year. Orders for boats have now been placed at private sector shipyards in an effort to boost production. The Government has accepted the need to create the post of maritime security adviser, a three-star officer from the Indian Navy, with a Maritime Security Advisory Board (MSAB) to coordinate all the 15 agencies responsible for maritime activities. But this is yet to materialise even a year after the attacks.

by S.U.

WHAT'S DONE

- More patrol vessels and aircraft for Coast Guard sanctioned
- Aircraft for Coast Guard increased
- 30 per cent increase in manpower sanctioned

WHAT'S NOT

- Domestic shipbuilding yet to be speeded up. Still takes five years to build a patrol vessel.
- Regulation of all landing points in coastal cities not done
- Marine police not allowed to use speedboats operated by Customs



GUARD ALONG WITH A TECHNOLOGICAL UPGRADE.



■ Jammu and Kashmir GROPING AROUND

The quiet political dialogue is yet to deliver

The 26/11 attacks may have generated war hysteria in the country but ironically Kashmir—which has been at the centre of acrimony between India and Pakistan—became a source of confidence for Delhi. The attacks came just after phase two of the seven-phased elections for the state Assembly. As heavy polling continued even afterwards, the Manmohan Singh Government interpreted the successful elections as a “defeat of separatism”.

That, everyone knew, was simply not true. Union Home Minister P. Chidambaram who appeared to acknowledge the difficult political situation in Kashmir, announced an offer of a “quiet dialogue” for resolving the issue. Later, the prime minister declared open a season of dialogue with separatists during his recent visit to the state in an attempt to consolidate the gains from the polling.

On the security front, the Government has moved to enhance its control in the state, banning pre-paid cell-phones. Top security officials say the ban was aimed to “prevent another Mumbai-like attack” feared by the intelligence agencies. While the situation seems to be under control but an incident like alleged rape and murder of two young women in Shopian goes to show that the Valley continues to remain on the edge and needs a spark to explode. Experts say the security situation is reaching a tipping point. Change cannot be envisioned unless the dialogue process is not seen as an event to further manage the conflict but institutionalised to achieve a political solution to Kashmir.

by Aljaz Hussain

WHAT'S DONE

- Enhanced security and surveillance in Kashmir Valley
- Acknowledgement that Kashmir is a political issue
- Initiation of dialogue

WHAT'S NOT

- Confidence-building measures like demilitarisation of civilian areas and repeal of impunity laws
- Infrastructure development
- Institutionalisation of the dialogue process